

“Android has been ruling and will continue to rule in the future as well”

Motorola has been faring very well in the Indian smartphone market with the launch of Moto E, Moto G and Moto X. The company wants to take its success to another level with the new Moto G and new Moto X smartphones, and the Moto 360 smartwatch. Motorola launched these three devices in India recently and is still banking on the pure Android experience. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** caught up with **Amit Boni, General Manager, Motorola**, during the launch event in New Delhi and discussed the company's Android strategy. Read on...



Amit Boni, India head, Motorola

Q What was the response to Motorola's recent brand re-launch?

We re-launched the brand in February. At that time we believed we were purely re-launching the brand but it turned into something much beyond that. Consumers just went crazy over our products. I think what we have been able to accomplish in the past 6-7 months was beyond our imagination. I am pretty sure that most of the people did not think that Motorola would be able to create such a benchmark with its products. I think we have had an absolutely smashing bunch of products. Our partnership with Flipkart has been phenomenal. We have made sure that we take care of the customers very well, not only at the time of buying, but even beyond that. These are the few things that are really paying back.

Q When you launched the first edition of Moto G in India, you faced a stock crunch. How do you plan to handle that situation with the new Moto G2 (2014)?

When we brought Moto G to India, we clearly underestimated the demand. But this time, we have better plans and better estimates. We have evolved much beyond the stage we were at during the launch of Moto G and Moto E. So hopefully, we will not face a supply crunch this time, although we don't have a sales target, as such. We would like to focus on products that deliver value and on our promises to the end consumers. We have been able to sell over a million Motorola devices up till now, including the Moto G, Moto E and Moto X. We hope to build upon what we have already achieved.

Q Motorola has always believed in Stock Android, but will things change after Lenovo completes its acquisition of your firm?

We are very focused on delivering the pure Android experience. So we are totally sure that we are not going to do any tweaking of pure Android. Having Stock Android helps us do a lot of things. People truly love the purest form of Android. Lots of companies think that putting a skin on Android gives them an edge, but I don't think so. The skins added to Android by the OEMs just make the devices bulky and slows them down. Stock Android is really helping us bring the latest and greatest Google experiences to our customers. I think this is something that has really worked well and so we will continue doing the same in the future as well. What we focus on is bringing out amazing devices, which are better than the previous ones. For us, that is the only war we have to fight.

Q So, since you are not working on the software part of the device, what do you think is the differentiator for your devices? Are you focusing on the hardware side of things?

Hardware is not just about the specs. The best specs do not necessarily mean the biggest processor or RAM. People can give you octa-core and then you will realise that your battery is draining in barely two hours. So we make sure that when we offer a device, you live it throughout the day and